MILIND SHELTE



SAFFRON TURN Chavan joins the BJP in the presence of deputy CM Devendra Fadnavis and party state chief Chandrashekhar Bawankule in Mumbai, Feb. 13

MAHARASHTRA/CONGRESS

CHAVAN WEARS LOTUS ON HIS SLEEVE

By Anilesh S. Mahajan

In an election season marked by the dissolution of alliances and politicians crossing party lines, former Maharashtra chief minister Ashok Chavan is the latest to depart from the Congress ranks. He joins several other former CMs who have deserted the Grand Old Party in the past decade, with many of them

CHIEF DEFECTORS

Some former Congress chief ministers who have quit the party in the past decade

JAMMU & KASHMIR



Ghulam Nabi Azad
↘ **After Congress:** Formed his own party, the Democratic Progressive Azad Party
↘ **Why he quit:** Questioned the leadership skills of Rahul Gandhi and the 'demolition' of internal party institutions

PUNJAB



Captain Amarinder Singh
↘ **After Congress:** Formed the Punjab Lok Congress, which flopped in the assembly poll. Merged the party into the BJP. Now, he's part of the BJP's national executive. Daughter Jai Inder Kaur is the BJP's state women wing chief
↘ **Why he quit:** Was upset after being unceremoniously sacked from the CM post. Blamed Rahul and Priyanka Gandhi for it

UTTARAKHAND



Vijay Bahuguna
↘ **After Congress:** Joined the BJP. Son Saket Bahuguna is now a minister in the Uttarakhand BJP government
↘ **Why he quit:** Objected to the elevation of his bête noire Harish Rawat as the state's CM

MAHARASHTRA



Narayan Rane
↘ **After Congress:** Joined the BJP. Now a Union cabinet minister
↘ **Why he quit:** Was the Shiv Sena's Maharashtra CM, but later joined the Congress before switching to the BJP in 2019



Ashok Chavan
↘ **After Congress:** Joined the BJP, just a day after quitting the Congress
↘ **Why he quit:** Was upset with the local leadership and blamed the central leadership for failing to control local party affairs

GOA



Digambar Kamat
↘ **After Congress:** Joined the BJP
↘ **Why he quit:** Blamed the party's top leadership for ignoring the party affairs in Goa



Pratapsingh Rane
↘ **After Congress:** The six-time CM quit politics. Son Viswajit Rane is a minister in Pramod Sawant-led BJP government. Daughter-in-law Deviya Rane is a BJP MLA
↘ **Why he quit:** Pressure from his son to quit the Congress



Luizinho Faleiro
↘ **After Congress:** Joined the Trinamool Congress. Later, became their Rajya Sabha member
↘ **Why he quit:** Called the local unit of the party a "cruel parody of what the Congress stands for"

KARNATAKA



S.M. Krishna
↘ **After Congress:** Joined the BJP and later retired from public life
↘ **Why he quit:** Criticised Rahul's working style

ANDHRA PRADESH



Kiran Kumar Reddy
↘ **After Congress:** Joined the BJP. Now part of its national executive
↘ **Why he quit:** Blamed the Congress leadership for ignoring state leaders

ARUNACHAL PRADESH



Pema Khandu
↘ **After Congress:** Joined the People's Party of Arunachal along with 43 MLAs in 2016; later defected to the BJP
↘ **Why he quit:** Wanted to be a part of the 'development agenda' of the BJP